

Image 5.1: Bannu district in erstwhile NWFP
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

That same day, he met Maj. Gen. Kulwant Singh and Maj. Gen. P. N. Thapar and briefed them about the information he had about Operation Gulmarg. Both Thapar and Singh were unconvinced, but were duty-bound to take him to meet the Defence Minister, Sardar Baldev Singh, on 19 October.[8] The invasion was three days away. A sceptical Baldev Singh asked the army's Intelligence Directorate to verify Kalkat's account. However, the British-staffed Intelligence Directorate paid no heed to Kalkat's account and no action was taken!

Deception and Disinterest

The Intelligence Directorate's reaction has to be assessed in the perspective of other warning signals on the impending invasion that were being flagged in other areas. On 15 October 1947, the new Prime Minister of Jammu and Kashmir, Justice Mehr Chand Mahajan, met a group of Hindu and Sikh refugees who had reached Srinagar, by crossing the border at Domel. They